

Taste Engine

Neighborhood-aware culinary intelligence

Turning local taste signals into operational menu strategy for fast-casual brands.

1 / 12
0:00 – 0:30 · Cold open

Brands run quarterly menu planning

Chipotle shortened its limited-time-offer cycle. CAVA does four seasonal menus a year. The bottleneck isn't creativity — it's neighborhood-level intelligence.

 Taste Engine

Neighborhood

- ☐  West Hollywood
- ☐  Williamsburg
- ☒  Mission District

Powered by Bright Data

- 64,372 dated indie reviews
- 391 restaurants · 3 metro markets · 24 months
- 240 brand SKUs · 2,660 flavor mentions

Neighborhood-aware culinary intelligence — turning local taste signals into operational menu strategy.



Mission District

Metro market US-CA-807 · cross-source neighborhood-level signal · sourced via Bright Data

Restaurants

138

Reviews

12,861

[Overview](#) [Recommendations](#) [Trends](#) [vs Naive LLM](#) [Evidence](#) [Methodology](#)

PILLAR 1

Signal Fusion

National Trends × local indie reviews, weighted honestly.

PILLAR 2

Trend Maturity

Competitive vs leading pool spread → Rising / Established / Peak.

PILLAR 3

Innovation Feasibility

Pantry lift tier + rollout portability + LTO history.

>  Glossary — industry terms in plain language

GAP-FILL OPPORTUNITY

Chipotle

Confidence 68

PEAK

Lift LOW · NATIONAL

Add mole to Chipotle

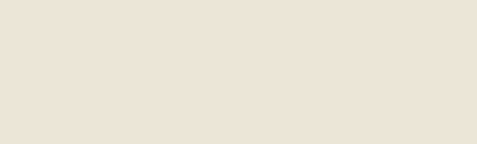
Mole is the #1 ranked signal in Mission District (signal_score 0.865, 132 reviews_hit, 92 competitive + 40 leading mentions across 12 indie restaurants). A 'Chicken Mole Bowl' or mole-drizzled burrito would slot naturally next to existing a

Evidence: 92 indie competitive mentions · 69 in last 12 months · Google Trends 73/100

The Mission is a Mexican-burrito institution layered with high-end fusion, putting concentrated pressure on Chipotle specifically and rewarding craft mole and birria over chain-style fillings.

HEADLINE SIGNAL

Birria is mentioned 159 times in the competitive indie pool (**Strong** (66/100)) versus 17 in the leading pool — the largest indie-vs-chef divergence in the entire dataset, and it's a four-SKU gap (birria, consommé, guajillo, ancho) for every brand.



Powered by Bright Data

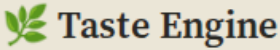
64,372 dated indie reviews · 383 restaurants · 3 metro markets · 24 months. Four Bright Data products: Google Maps Reviews Dataset, Fast Maps Search, SERP API, Scraping Browser.

Top signals — synopsis

Mole leads at *Very strong (86/100)* / *Very strong (86/100)* with 114 + 53 mentions and a

Pantry alignment

How well does each brand's current pantry intersect with the top



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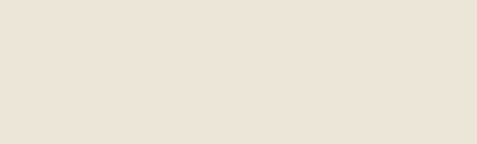
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3 / 12
1:00 – 2:00 · Act 1

Trend Maturity Spread

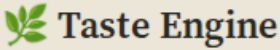
Indie restaurants tagged into competitive (lunch) vs leading (chef-driven) pools. The split between pools is structural and tells the maturity story.

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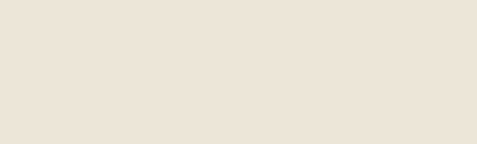
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4 / 12
1:00 – 2:00 · Act 1 continued

Same flavor, three cities, three stages

Williamsburg al pastor: 3 competitive, 8 leading → Rising, premature for chains. Mission: 58 competitive, 1 leading → Established, ship-now zone. WeHo: Established but thin.

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Williamsburg

Metro market [US-NY-501](#) · cross-source neighborhood-level signal · sourced via Bright Data

Restaurants

150

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31,010

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TOP RECOMMENDATION

Sweetgreen

Confidence 56

STEADY

Lift LOW · NATIONAL

Kimchi Crunch Bowl

Apple kimchi, miso-sesame ginger, crispy rice — a Williamsburg-tuned Korean bowl from pantry-only SKUs.

Evidence: 21 indie competitive mentions · 20 in last 12 months · Google Trends 45/100

Williamsburg's indie scene is Caribbean-led with a strong Israeli-Mediterranean second act, and chef pool and review pool agree more tightly here than in either other city.

HEADLINE SIGNAL

Jerk is the strongest single-flavor signal in the entire dataset — **Very strong** (91/100) on both pools, 44 indie mentions plus 69 leading mentions — and not one of the three chains can deliver it; Sweetgreen's gap alone needs four SKUs (jerk paste, allspice, scotch bonnet, thyme).

Top signals — synopsis

Jerk towers over everything (**Very strong** (91/100) / **Very strong** (91/100)) and oxtail

Pantry alignment

How well does each brand's current pantry intersect with the top trending flavors in this neighborhood? Measures current overlap

Validation: the system caught the shift before the brand announced

Between Q4 2025 and Q1 2026, al pastor crossed Weak → Established in Mission indie reviews. On January 27, Chipotle announced the al pastor relaunch for February 10. The classifier flipped first.

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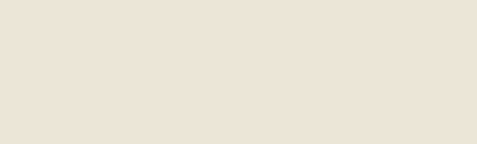
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The next call: Mole gap-fill for Chipotle in Mission

Mole is the strongest mover in Mission this quarter — +7 mentions, 132 total. None of the chains can deliver it from current pantry. Confidence 68. Peak maturity. Low operational lift, national rollout. Californios verified as the comp.

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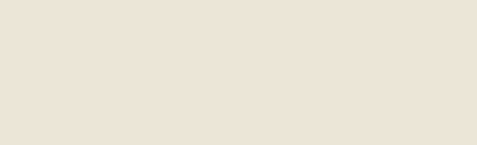
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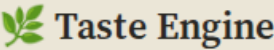
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Quarterly cadence — what changed and what's next

Every visit shows movers up (mole +7, al pastor +6, pesto +5), maturity transitions, and a directional forecast. Brands come back monthly for the deltas, not a one-shot analysis.



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QUARTERLY BRIEF

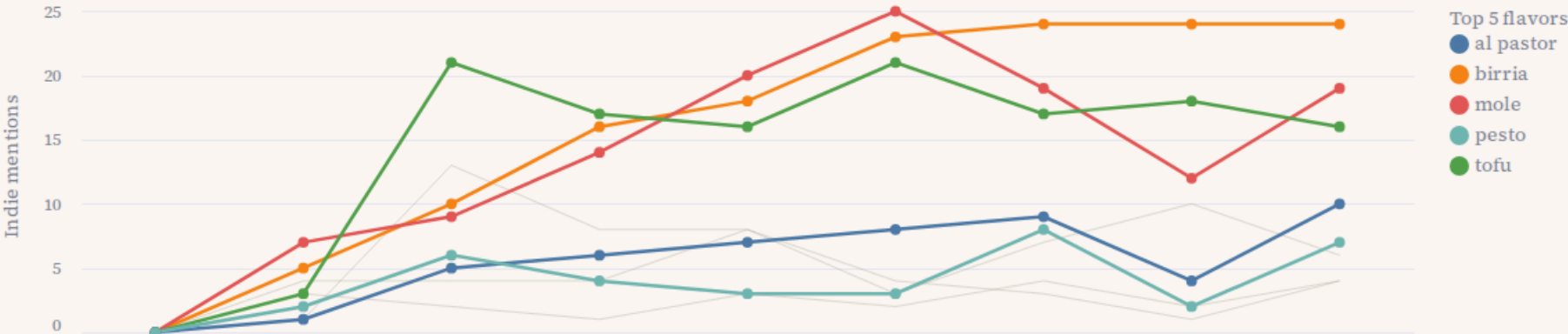
2026-Q1 · Mission District

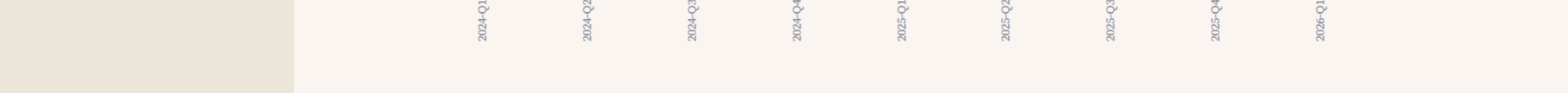
comparing to 2025-Q4
forecast horizon: 2026-Q2, 2026-Q3

pesto crossed from *Weak* to *Steady* between 2025-Q4 and 2026-Q1. **mole** is the quarter's top mover (+7 mentions). **birria** is forecast to keep rising (~27 mentions in Q2, ±2).

8-quarter trajectory · top flavors

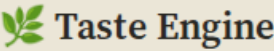
Each line is one flavor's mention count by quarter. Hover for the exact values. Dashed segment is the linear forecast.





Next-quarter forecasts with confidence bands

Mission birria forecast to rise to ~27 mentions in Q2 (± 2). Multi-snapshot Trends velocity and cross-city diffusion predictions are explicit v2 roadmap — accruing now.



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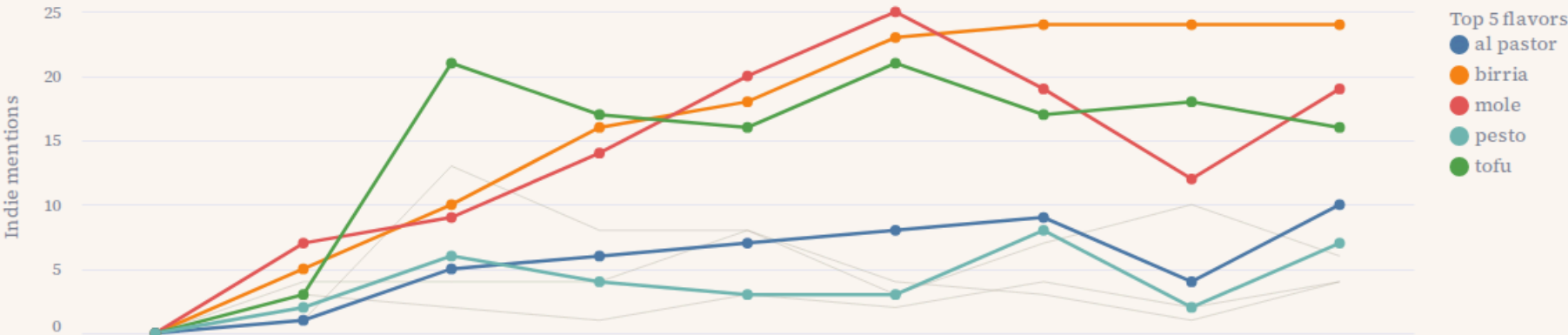
2026-Q1 · Mission District

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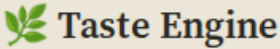
8-quarter trajectory · top flavors

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Eight hallucination classes caught. Naive LLM: zero.

Same model. Same prompt. The naive LLM hallucinated nine SKUs across two dishes and reinvented al pastor as a vegan mushroom dish — completely missing the actual brand decision happening live. The LLM is a reasoning layer; the pipeline is the innovation.



- Neighborhood
- ☐

🌴 West Hollywood
- ☐
- 🏠 Williamsburg

☒

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Naive LLM vs Taste Engine — same prompt, different rigor

Hallucination classes caught — Taste Engine

8

↑ deterministic, in code

Hallucination classes caught — naive LLM

0

↑ same model, no constraints

Pantry · duplication · LTO history · cuisine coherence · dish-name truthfulness · ambiguous terms · comp restaurant verification · numerical claim audit. Every one of these became an audit in code, not a prompt tweak.

We asked Claude Opus 4.7 the exact same question with no engine context. The naive output is the control; the Taste Engine card on the right is the treatment. Both used the same model.

PROMPT (asked of both)

"Recommend dishes for Chipotle to launch in the Mission District of San Francisco based on current food trends in that neighborhood. Give me 2 specific dish concepts with ingredients and rationale."

NAIVE LLM (CONTROL) claude-opus-4-7

Chipotle x Mission District: 2 Dish Concepts

The Mission is a unique collision of deep-rooted Latino food culture (it's the birthplace of the Mission burrito), a strong wave/plant for red sauce, and trend-chasing foodies. Here are

TASTE ENGINE (TREATMENT) same model + pipeline

SHIP NOW

Al Pastor + Queso Pasa

mission burrito), a strong vegan/plant-forward scene, and trend-chasing foodies. Here are two dishes tailored to that mix:

Al Pastor Guac Bowl

The hero LTO, anchored for a neighborhood where al pastor is everywhere.

Confidence 76

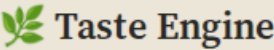
ESTABLISHED

PROVEN · 2023, 2024, 2026

10 / 12
Recommendations surface

Six recommendations per neighborhood — every claim tool-validated

Two cards per brand × three brands. Each card carries confidence (0-100), maturity stage, lift tier, rollout portability, proven badge with newsroom URLs, and comp restaurant verification.



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PILLAR 2 — TREND MATURITY · PILLAR 3 — INNOVATION FEASIBILITY

Recommendations · Mission District

6 dishes per city (2 per brand). Every claim runs through 8 deterministic audits before reaching this card.

► What the badges mean

Show brands:

Chipotle × CAVA × Sweetgreen ×

CHIPOTLE · 2 recommendations

SHIP NOW

Al Pastor Guac Bowl

The hero LTO, anchored for a neighborhood where al pastor is everywhere.

Confidence 76 ESTABLISHED PROVEN · 2023, 2024, 2026

58 indie mentions · 34 in last 12 months · Google Trends 17/100

Insight: Mission District is a neighborhood where al pastor is everywhere. This is a strong signal for a dish like Al Pastor Guac Bowl.

GAP FILL

Add: mole

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Confidence 68 PEAK Lift LOW · NATIONAL

92 indie mentions · 69 in last 12 months · Google Trends 73/100

Insight: Mission District is a neighborhood where mole is a strong signal. This is a strong signal for a dish like Add: mole.

		low lift · national · proven 3x	1 new SKU · national rollout · 1 comp verified	
		► Why we recommend this · methodology	► Why we recommend this · methodology	

11 / 12
4:15 – 4:45 · Close

Taste Engine

Neighborhood-aware culinary intelligence

Built on Bright Data. Quarterly intelligence brief for brand strategy teams. Demo coverage: Chipotle, CAVA, Sweetgreen across Mission District, Williamsburg, West Hollywood.

12 / 12